



GRADE 8 – ENGLISH OLYMPIAD

SECTION -WORD AND STRUCTURE KNOWLEDGE

Questions 1–30 | 1 mark each

Q1. Choose the synonym of the underlined word.

The scientist was meticulous in recording every observation.

- A. careless
- B. precise
- C. impatient
- D. confused

Q2. Choose the antonym of “scarce”.

- A. rare
- B. limited
- C. abundant
- D. insufficient

Q3. Choose the correctly spelt word.

- A. Consciencious
- B. Conscientious
- C. Conscientous
- D. Conscintious

Q4. Choose the word that best completes the analogy.

Book : Author :: Painting : _____

- A. Reader
- B. Artist
- C. Gallery



D. Colour

Q5. Choose the correct one-word substitution.

A person who studies ancient societies and cultures is an:

A. astronomer

B. archaeologist

C. anthropologist

D. astrologer

Q6. Choose the correct plural form of "criterion".

A. criterions

B. criteriones

C. criteria

D. criterias

Q7. Choose the correct form of the verb.

Neither the teacher nor the students _____ aware of the change in schedule.

A. was

B. is

C. were

D. has

Q8. Identify the adjective in the sentence.

The remarkably talented musician performed brilliantly.

A. remarkably

B. talented

C. musician

D. brilliantly



Q9. Choose the correct preposition.

She has been working on this project _____ Monday.

- A. for
- B. since
- C. from
- D. by

Q10. Choose the correct conjunction.

_____ he was tired, he completed the assignment.

- A. Because
- B. Although
- C. Unless
- D. Since

Q11. Choose the correctly punctuated sentence.

- A. Riya said "I will finish it tomorrow".
- B. Riya said, "I will finish it tomorrow."
- C. Riya said "I will finish it tomorrow."
- D. Riya said, I will finish it tomorrow.

Q12. Choose the correct passive voice.

The committee will announce the results tomorrow.

- A. The results are announced by the committee tomorrow.
- B. The results will be announced by the committee tomorrow.
- C. The results were announced by the committee tomorrow.
- D. The results have been announced by the committee tomorrow.

Q13. Choose the correct indirect speech.



Aman said, "I have completed my homework."

- A. Aman said that I have completed my homework.
- B. Aman said that he had completed his homework.
- C. Aman says that he completed my homework.
- D. Aman said that he has completed his homework.

Q14. Choose the correct modal.

You _____ wear a helmet while riding a motorcycle.

- A. might
- B. could
- C. must
- D. would

Q15. Identify the type of sentence.

"Please close the window."

- A. Interrogative
- B. Exclamatory
- C. Imperative
- D. Assertive

Q16. Choose the correct phrasal verb.

The meeting was _____ because the manager was ill.

- A. called off
- B. called in
- C. called up
- D. called out

Q17. Choose the meaning of the idiom "to hit the nail on the head".



- A. To hurt someone
- B. To make a mistake
- C. To describe something exactly
- D. To work very slowly

Q18. Choose the correct homophone.

The old man walked _____ the narrow lane.

- A. threw
- B. through
- C. thorough
- D. thru

Q19. Choose the word that does NOT belong to the group.

- A. Mercury
- B. Venus
- C. Mars
- D. Moon

Q20. Arrange the words to form a meaningful sentence.

always / honesty / the / best / policy / is

- A. Honesty is always the best policy.
- B. Always honesty is the best policy.
- C. The best honesty is always policy.
- D. Is honesty always the best policy.

Q21. Choose the correct tense.

By the time we reached the station, the train _____.

- A. leaves



- B. has left
- C. had left
- D. was leaving

Q22. Choose the correct article.

He is _____ honest and hardworking employee.

- A. a
- B. an
- C. the
- D. no article

Q23. Choose the correct degree of comparison.

Mount Everest is _____ mountain in the world.

- A. higher
- B. highest
- C. the highest
- D. the higher

Q24. Identify the adverb in the sentence.

The children eagerly waited for the results.

- A. children
- B. eagerly
- C. waited
- D. results

Q25. Choose the correct question tag.

You have finished your work, _____?

- A. haven't you?



B. don't you?

C. didn't you?

D. won't you?

Q26. Choose the word closest in meaning to "reluctant".

A. unwilling

B. excited

C. confident

D. eager

Q27. Choose the correct collective noun.

A _____ of stars was visible in the clear sky.

A. bunch

B. constellation

C. troop

D. pack

Q28. Choose the correctly spelt word.

A. Privilege

B. Privelege

C. Priviledge

D. Privillage

Q29. Identify the figure of speech.

"The wind whispered through the trees."

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Personification



D. Hyperbole

Q30. Choose the correct word.

The new law will have a significant _____ on the environment.

A. affect

B. effect

C. effects

D. effected

SECTION 2 – READING

Questions 31–40 | 1 mark each

Read the passage carefully and answer Questions 31–35.

For centuries, people have looked at the night sky with curiosity. Ancient civilisations observed the movement of stars and planets and used their observations to create calendars and predict seasonal changes. Today, astronomers use powerful telescopes and spacecraft to study objects that are millions or even billions of kilometres away.

One of the most fascinating objects in space is a black hole. A black hole is a region of space where gravity is so strong that even light cannot escape from it. Scientists cannot see black holes directly, but they can detect their presence by observing how they affect nearby stars and gases.

Modern space research has helped us understand not only distant galaxies but also our own planet. Satellites help scientists monitor weather, study climate change and track natural disasters. Thus, looking into space can also help us understand and protect Earth.

Q31. Why did ancient civilisations observe the stars?

A. To build spacecraft

B. To create calendars and predict seasonal changes

C. To study black holes

D. To monitor climate change



Q32. What makes a black hole special?

- A. It produces sunlight.
- B. It is made entirely of gas.
- C. Its gravity is so strong that light cannot escape.
- D. It can be seen with the naked eye.

Q33. How do scientists detect black holes?

- A. By travelling inside them
- B. By observing their effect on nearby objects
- C. By photographing them directly
- D. By listening to them

Q34. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a use of satellites?

- A. Monitoring weather
- B. Studying climate change
- C. Tracking natural disasters
- D. Predicting earthquakes with complete accuracy

Q35. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Ancient people were better scientists.
- B. Black holes are the only important objects in space.
- C. Studying space increases our understanding of the universe and Earth.
- D. Satellites are more useful than telescopes.

Read the passage carefully and answer Questions 36–40.

Failure is often considered the opposite of success, but many successful people see it differently. Failure can reveal weaknesses, provide valuable experience and encourage people to



try new approaches. A student who performs poorly in an examination, for example, can analyse the mistakes and change their method of preparation.

However, learning from failure requires honesty. Blaming others may make a person feel better temporarily, but it prevents them from understanding what went wrong. A person who accepts responsibility can identify areas for improvement.

Failure, therefore, should not be treated as a permanent label. It is an event from which one can learn. What matters most is how a person responds after experiencing it.

Q36. According to the passage, failure can:

- A. always prevent success
- B. provide valuable experience
- C. make people stop learning
- D. eliminate weaknesses immediately

Q37. What should a student do after performing poorly in an examination?

- A. Blame the teacher
- B. Ignore the result
- C. Analyse mistakes and change preparation methods
- D. Stop studying

Q38. Why is honesty important after failure?

- A. It helps a person understand what went wrong.
- B. It makes failure disappear.
- C. It makes others responsible.
- D. It guarantees success.

Q39. What does the phrase “permanent label” suggest?

- A. Something that cannot be changed
- B. A school identity card
- C. A temporary experience



D. A reward

Q40. Which statement best expresses the author's view?

- A. Successful people never fail.
- B. Failure should always be avoided.
- C. Failure can become a learning opportunity.
- D. Failure is caused mainly by other people.

SECTION 3 – SPOKEN AND WRITTEN EXPRESSION

Questions 41–45 | 1 mark each

Q41. Your friend has won a painting competition. What would be the most appropriate response?

- A. "You were lucky this time."
- B. "Congratulations! Your hard work really paid off."
- C. "I knew you would lose."
- D. "Why did they choose you?"

Q42. You need to borrow a book from your teacher. Which sentence is most appropriate?

- A. Give me that book.
- B. I want your book now.
- C. Could I please borrow this book for a few days?
- D. You must give me this book.

Q43. Your friend says, "I am nervous about my presentation." What would be an appropriate response?

- A. "You will definitely fail."
- B. "Don't worry. Prepare well and speak confidently."
- C. "That's not my problem."
- D. "You should cancel it."



Q44. Choose the most appropriate opening for a formal letter to the Principal.

- A. Hi Principal!
- B. Dear buddy,
- C. Respected Sir/Madam,
- D. Hello there!

Q45. Choose the best sentence for a formal email requesting information.

- A. Send me the details ASAP.
- B. I wanna know the details.
- C. Could you please provide me with the required information?
- D. Give details quickly.

SECTION 4 – ACHIEVERS SECTION

Questions 46–50 | 3 marks each

Q46. Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence.

Hardly _____ the match begun when it _____ to rain heavily.

- A. had / began
- B. has / begins
- C. did / began
- D. had / had begun

Q47. Read the sentence and choose the correct option.

“Although the road was flooded, the rescue team continued their journey because several villagers were still stranded.”

Which option best explains the relationship between the ideas?

- A. The rescue team stopped because the road was flooded.
- B. The villagers caused the road to flood.



- C. The rescue team continued despite the difficulty because people needed help.
- D. The villagers refused to be rescued.

Q48. Choose the grammatically correct sentence.

- A. Neither of the two answers are correct.
- B. Neither of the two answers is correct.
- C. Neither of the two answer are correct.
- D. Neither of two answers were correct.

Q49. Read the sentence carefully.

“Having completed the project, Rohan submitted it to the principal before the deadline.”

Which statement is correct?

- A. Rohan submitted the project before completing it.
- B. Rohan completed the project after the deadline.
- C. Rohan completed the project and then submitted it before the deadline.
- D. The principal completed the project.

Q50. Choose the best option to complete the paragraph.

Maya wanted to participate in the inter-school debate. She knew that the competition would be difficult. _____, she decided to participate because she wanted to overcome her fear of public speaking.

- A. Therefore
- B. Nevertheless
- C. For example
- D. Similarly



ANSWER KEY

1.B

2.C

3.B

4.B

5.B

6.C

7.C

8.B



9.B

10.B

11.B

12.B

13.B

14.C

15.C

16.A

17.C

18.B

19.D

20.A

21.C

22.B

23.C

24.B

25.A

26.A

27.B

28.A

29.C

30.B

31.B

32.C



33.B

34.D

35.C

36.B

37.C

38.A

39.A

40.C

41.B

42.C

43.B

44.C

45.C

46.A

47.C

48.B

49.C

50.B